

ProffileSA — Investor Pitch Deck

Seed Round

"LinkedIn shows you what people claim. ProffileSA shows you what they've proven. That single distinction is worth billions."

Slide 1 — Cover

PROFFILE *The Verified Professional Trust Graph*

Operating as **ProffileSA** (seed stage) Seed Round — [Year] [Founder Name] — Founder & CEO
proffilesa.com

Slide 2 — The Hook

Right now, somewhere in South Africa:

A brilliant self-taught developer from Khayelitsha is being filtered out of a job application by an ATS that doesn't see a university degree.

A hiring manager is about to make a R800,000 hiring mistake because the candidate's CV and references were fabricated.

A manager who built a legendary team has no way to publicly vouch for the people she developed — except a LinkedIn endorsement nobody trusts.

The entire professional world runs on reputation. But reputation has never been verifiable. Until now.

Slide 3 — The Problem

Three problems. One root cause.

The root cause: Professional reputation is self-reported, isolated, and unverifiable.

Problem 1 — CVs Are Fiction Studies estimate 30%+ of CVs in South Africa contain false information. Fabricated degrees. Inflated titles. Reference contacts who are friends, not former managers. Employers know this — and still cannot systematically solve it.

Problem 2 — The Hidden Job Market 70–80% of jobs are filled through networks and referrals. Talented people without the right connections are structurally locked out — not because they lack skills, but because they lack access to the trust graph. The graph exists. It's just invisible.

Problem 3 — Reputation is Fragmented and Non-Portable You have a rating on Upwork. Stars on Airbnb. GitHub contributions. LinkedIn endorsements. A verbal reference from a manager who thinks you're exceptional. None of it is connected. None of it travels with you. Every platform starts from zero trust. This is why fraud is a trillion-dollar global problem.

Slide 4 — The Insight

This is the Larry Page moment. The insight that makes everything else make sense.

A job title is a self-reported web page. A verified review from your actual manager is a backlink. Backlinks beat self-reporting. Always.

PageRank organised the web by mapping who links to whom and treating links as votes of credibility.

Profile organises professional reputation by mapping who vouches for whom and treating verified reviews as credibility signals.

LinkedIn indexes what you **claim**. Profile indexes what you've **proven**.

One sentence. Billion-dollar gap.

Slide 5 — The Solution

The Verified Professional Profile

Profile replaces the CV with a living, verified professional record.

What it looks like:

KAGISO MOKOENA

★ 91/100

Backend Developer · Johannesburg

Proffile Score: 91 | 8 verified reviews

WORK HISTORY (verified)

▶ WeThinkCode – Teaching Assistant (2022–2023)

★★★★★ "Kagiso elevated every student in the room."

– Nomvula Dlamini, Programme Director ✓

★★★★★ "Rare combination of technical skill and patience."

– James Osei, Senior Instructor ✓

▶ Bash.com – Backend Developer (2023–present)

★★★★★ "Delivered our entire payments API. Exceptional."

– Sarah Khumalo, CTO ✓

VERIFIED SKILLS

Node.js ✓x6 | PostgreSQL ✓x4 | Python ✓x3

PLATFORM SIGNALS

GitHub: 4 years active · 1,240 contributions ⚡

No degree. No LinkedIn network. Just proof.

Slide 6 — Product (The Full Conspiracy)

Proffile launches as one product. It expands into ownership of every layer of professional trust.

Phase	Product	What We Own
1	Proffile Profile — verified CV replacement	Professional identity
2	Proffile Recruit — hiring graph intelligence	Talent acquisition
3	Proffile API — portable trust score	Platform trust infrastructure
4	Proffile Verify — instant CV verification	Background check industry
5	Proffile Identity — professional passport	The identity layer of professional Africa

By Phase 5: Any professional in Africa proving their credentials, any employer verifying a candidate, any platform needing to trust a human — runs through Proffile.

Slide 7 — The Built-In Viral Loop

Proofile doesn't need a marketing budget to grow. Growth is built into the product's mechanics.

```
graph TD; A[Professional creates profile] --> B[Invites manager to leave a verified review]; B --> C[Manager receives personal email from Proofile]; C --> D[Manager completes review (takes 2 minutes)]; D --> E[Manager's name + review is now publicly on Proofile]; E --> F[Manager is proud → shares it → creates own profile]; F --> G[Manager invites their own reviewers]; G --> H[Graph grows in both directions];
```

Professional creates profile
↓
Invites manager to leave a verified review
↓
Manager receives personal email from Proofile
↓
Manager completes review (takes 2 minutes)
↓
Manager's name + review is now publicly on Proofile
↓
Manager is proud → shares it → creates own profile
↓
Manager invites their own reviewers
↓
Graph grows in both directions

Every review request is a marketing touch to someone new. Every completed review creates two potential new users.

This is the two-sided viral loop. It builds the graph automatically.

Slide 8 — Why Now. Why SA. Why Us.

Why Now

- Remote work has made professional reputation more important and harder to verify than ever before
- South Africa's fake CV problem has reached crisis point — it's in the national news regularly
- AI tools have made sophisticated CV fraud cheaper and easier — the traditional reference call cannot keep up

Why South Africa First

- 32%+ unemployment means the stakes of the hiring decision are enormous — employers cannot afford bad hires, candidates cannot afford unfair filters
- SA has high smartphone penetration and active professional LinkedIn culture — the behaviour exists, the platform doesn't

- SA is the most developed tech and business ecosystem in Africa — the right wedge market before expanding to Nigeria, Kenya, Egypt, and beyond
- The fake CV problem is uniquely acute here — 30%+ CV fraud rate gives Profile an urgent, specific problem to solve

Why This Founder

- Built by someone who lived the problem — a Wits CS dropout whose skills were real but whose credentials were not
 - The best founders build for the person they used to be
 - Deep knowledge of the SA tech ecosystem, its talent gaps, and its hiring dysfunction
 - [Add your specific relevant experience, things you've built, communities you're part of]
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Slide 9 — Traction

(Update with real numbers as you build)

Pre-launch validation:

- [N] founding users recruited and onboarded personally
- [N] review requests sent in private beta
- [X]% review completion rate (target: 40%+)
- [N] hiring managers interviewed — [X]% said they would pay for verified candidate profiles
- [N] bootcamp partnerships in discussion (WeThinkCode, HyperionDev, CodeSpace)
- Organic reach: [N] views on founder launch post / TikTok concept video

The behaviour validation: Managers already write LinkedIn recommendations. They already take reference calls. They already informally vouch for former reports on WhatsApp. The behaviour exists. We are giving it a credible, permanent, verifiable home.

Slide 10 — Market Size

South Africa (Launch Market)

- Employed professionals: **16 million**
- Estimated SA recruitment market: **R8 billion/year**
- Background check / verification market: **R2 billion/year**
- LinkedIn Recruiter ARPU equivalent in SA market: **R120,000/year per seat**

Africa (3–5 Year Horizon)

- Africa's working-age population: **600 million+** (fastest growing in the world)
- African e-recruitment market: **\$1.2 billion** (2024), growing 15% annually
- Underserved by Western platforms — LinkedIn penetration in Africa is a fraction of US/Europe

Global Trust Infrastructure (Long-Term)

- Global identity verification market: **\$18 billion** (2024), growing to **\$38 billion** by 2030
 - Global background screening market: **\$5.8 billion**
 - Every marketplace, gig platform, fintech, and SaaS needing to trust humans is a potential API customer
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Slide 11 — Business Model

We monetise every layer of the trust stack we own:

Individual (Free + Premium)

- **Free forever:** Create a profile, request reviews, share your Profile
- **Profile Premium:** R79/month — profile analytics, "who viewed you", priority search placement, custom URL, PDF export

B2B Recruitment

- **Profile Recruit:** R2,500–R15,000/month — verified candidate search, hiring graph intelligence, ATS integration
- Target: 50 paying accounts by Month 12 post-launch = R500,000 MRR

API / Infrastructure

- **Profile API:** R500–R8,000/month + usage — portable trust score for any platform
- Target: 30 API customers by Month 24 = R300,000 MRR

Verification

- **Profile Verify:** R150/candidate verification — instant CV cross-check against the graph
- Enterprise subscription: R10,000/month unlimited
- Target: R750,000 MRR by Phase 4

Revenue Trajectory

Year	Revenue	Key Driver
Year 1	R0 (build the asset)	Graph construction
Year 2	R6,000,000	Proffile Recruit subscriptions
Year 3	R18,000,000	Recruit + API + Verify
Year 4	R60,000,000	Full platform + continental expansion

Slide 12 — Competitive Landscape

Platform	What They Do	The Gap
LinkedIn	Self-reported professional profiles + endorsements	Nobody verifies anything. Endorsements are meaningless. No real hiring graph.
Indeed / PNet	Job listings and applications	No reputation layer. Candidate quality is opaque.
MIE / Managed Integrity	Background checks (formal records, criminal)	Expensive, slow, no social/professional layer, not scalable for SMEs
Upwork / Freelancer	Freelance marketplaces with ratings	Isolated to their platform. Not portable. Not cross-sector.
References on request	The phone call nobody makes	Verbal, unrecorded, biased, easily faked

The gap nobody has filled: A verified, portable, social professional trust graph that is both consumer-facing (beautiful profile) and infrastructure (API-accessible score).

Our moat once built:

- **Data moat:** 3 years of SA verified professional relationships cannot be replicated
- **Network effect:** The graph is more valuable with every verified review added
- **Trust moat:** Proffile Score becomes the market standard — employers and platforms trust it because everyone uses it

Slide 13 — The Team

[Founder Name] — Founder & CEO

- CS background at Wits University
- [Relevant projects, products built, communities you're part of]
- Built by someone who needed this product and couldn't find it
- Deep roots in SA tech ecosystem

Roles being recruited / advised:

- Head of Engineering — React/Node.js background, graph database experience preferred
- SA Legal Counsel — employment law + data privacy (POPIA) specialist
- Growth Lead — SA professional community expertise
- Advisory board: SA HR industry veteran, fintech/API executive, SA VC-connected operator

Slide 14 — The Ask

Raising: R[X]M Seed Round

Use of Funds

Allocation	%	Detail
Product & Engineering	45%	MVP build + Phase 2 recruit product
Growth & Community	25%	Founding user recruitment, bootcamp partnerships, content
Legal & Compliance	15%	POPIA, employment law counsel, domain acquisition (\$10k)
Operations	10%	Infrastructure, tools, team admin
Reserve	5%	3-month buffer

What This Round Buys

- 10,000 verified profiles (Month 6)
- 30,000 verified review edges in the graph (Month 6)
- Profile Recruit live and generating revenue (Month 9)
- 50 paying B2B recruiter accounts (Month 12)
- Series A ready with R500,000 MRR (Month 18)
- profile.com + profile.app domain acquisition (Month 3)

The Offer

- [X]% equity / SAFE note at [cap]
 - Board observer seat for lead investor
 - First right of participation in Series A
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Slide 15 — The Vision (Close)

In 1998, Larry Page noticed that a hyperlink is a citation — and that the web's link structure was an unmapped graph of credibility signals. He built PageRank to organise it. The result was Google.

Professional reputation is the same unmapped graph. Every manager who vouches for a former employee. Every colleague who worked alongside someone and saw what they were really capable of. Every client who paid for work and can speak to its quality. These are citations. These are backlinks. They exist everywhere — and they have never been organised.

ProoffileSA maps this graph. Verifies every edge. And makes it accessible.

We start in South Africa because the problem is acute, the market is ready, and we are inside the problem. We expand across Africa because 600 million working-age people deserve a professional identity that reflects what they've actually done — not just which institutions they had access to.

The CV has been broken since it was invented. Reference calls have been theatre since anyone can remember. LinkedIn endorsements are decorative.

Proof is what matters. Prooffile is proof.

Appendix A — POPIA & Legal Compliance

South Africa's Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA) governs all personal data on the platform.

Key commitments:

- Explicit informed consent at signup for all data categories
- Public reviews are attributed — the reviewer's name is always shown (accountability mechanism)
- Users have full right to access, correct, and delete their data
- API data is exclusively aggregated and anonymised — no individual profiles shared via API without explicit user consent
- A designated POPIA Information Officer is appointed from launch

- Full legal review by SA data privacy counsel before launch
 - Employment law counsel review of review/defamation policy
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Appendix B — Key Questions & Answers

"Won't managers refuse to leave public reviews — too much liability?" We make it opt-in and clearly voluntary. The review form includes a declaration. Legal language is plain and protective. Early evidence: managers already write LinkedIn recommendations (public) and take reference calls (verbal with no protection). Proofile is safer than both — written, consensual, disputable.

"What about defamatory reviews?" Our dispute mechanism allows any reviewed party to flag a review. Flagged reviews are paused pending investigation. We maintain legal counsel specifically for this. The fact that the reviewer's name is always attached dramatically reduces malicious review risk — anonymity is what enables review abuse on other platforms.

"Can't LinkedIn just build this?" LinkedIn is a US company with a \$26B acquisition price and a core product that is fundamentally self-reported. Pivoting to verified-only reviews would invalidate 90% of their existing content and alienate their user base. They are structurally unable to do what Proofile does. Google couldn't kill Reddit. Facebook couldn't kill WhatsApp. Purpose-built wins over general-purpose in trust-sensitive categories.

"Why won't someone copy this immediately?" The graph is the moat, not the interface. Copying the interface is trivial. Replicating 30,000 verified review edges and the trust signals they encode is not. Every day we run, our data advantage compounds. Speed of execution is the entire strategy.

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